

DC Site Intelligence

NexPhase Advisory

Across 20 priority US data-center markets, **California** leads NexPhase's Site Intelligence ranking at **7.2/10** on grid infrastructure depth and quality, followed by **Arizona** and **Oregon**. 6 of the 20 markets remain underdeveloped for data centers — open runway where grid infrastructure is ahead of current build-out.

RANKED MARKETS — TOP 10

#	State	Score	Market Tier	Depth S·M	Load Growth
1	CA California	7.2	Competitive Market	23·27	-2.4%
2	AZ Arizona	7.1	Competitive Market	8·32	+2.2%
3	OR Oregon	6.7	Competitive Market	7·29	+3.4%
4	WA Washington	5.9	Underdeveloped	2·19	-1.7%
5	NV Nevada	5.1	Emerging	2·2	-2.8%
6	FL Florida	5.1	Underdeveloped	3·11	+0.9%
7	CO Colorado	5.1	Underdeveloped	1·14	-2.1%
8	OH Ohio	4.4	Competitive Market	1·6	+0.9%
9	GA Georgia	4.3	Competitive Market	3·15	-2.0%
10	TN Tennessee	4.3	Emerging	0·4	-2.9%

TOP 3 MARKETS

California #1 · 7.2/10

California ranks #1 at 7.2/10, carried by 23 STRONG and 27 MODERATE density substations (avg 5.36/10 across 128 queue substations). As a competitive, built-out DC market, load growth is soft (-2.4% weighted), so the case rests on grid capacity rather than demand momentum.

Arizona #2 · 7.1/10

Arizona ranks #2 at 7.1/10, carried by 8 STRONG and 32 MODERATE density substations (avg 5.01/10 across 176 queue substations). As a competitive, built-out DC market, utility load is growing (+2.2% weighted).

Oregon #3 · 6.7/10

Oregon ranks #3 at 6.7/10, carried by 7 STRONG and 29 MODERATE density substations (avg 4.51/10 across 197 queue substations). As a competitive, built-out DC market, utility load is growing (+3.4% weighted).

METHODOLOGY

Each market is scored 1–10 from four factors; the three continuous factors are min-max normalized across the 20 states, then weighted:

- **Avg Infrastructure Density (35%)** — mean per-substation density score across the state's interconnection-queue substations (grid *quality*).
- **Infrastructure Depth (25%)** — normalized count of STRONG + MODERATE density substations (STRONG weighted 2x) — grid *breadth*, so distributed-grid states are not penalized for lacking a single dominant hub.
- **Weighted Load Growth (25%)** — utility retail-sales YoY growth, weighted by load; non-organic reporting outliers (>100%) excluded.
- **Competitive Market (15%)** — data-center *market* competition, NOT grid: a Competitive Market is built-out with more rivals for sites/power; less-developed markets score higher. Never indicates a thin grid.

“Competitive Market” means market-competition pressure, not absence of grid — a Competitive Market can still have deep, high-quality grid.

This report is a market screening tool. It identifies power-advantaged markets for further diligence. It does not replace utility service availability confirmation.

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Power Origination · Interconnection · Market Strategy

Data sources & vintage — Queue data: live as of 2026-06-27 | EIA substation data: 2023 vintage (EIA-860) | Utility load data: 2023 vintage (EIA-861).

Compiled from publicly available sources — ISO/RTO interconnection queue data, EIA-860 & EIA-861 surveys, and utility commission records. Analysis reflects NexPhase Advisory's independent professional assessment. Scores refresh weekly.